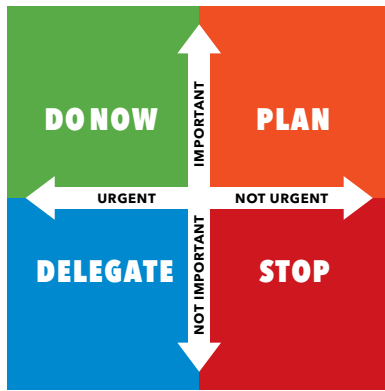




What is the Eisenhower Matrix?

The Eisenhower Matrix is a simple, effective decision-making tool for determining which tasks deserve our immediate action, our long-term attention, our delegation skills, and our circular bins. **BY SHARON SALINE, PSY.D.**

IT'S HUMAN NATURE. WHEN A FIRE sparks up, we drop everything to fight it. But in our ADHD lives, there are little fires everywhere. And we get so busy extinguishing flames sometimes that we can spend a whole day — maybe a week — spinning

around and around in a mess of fire retardant. We're exhausted but have nothing to show for our time or energy.

If this sounds familiar, let me introduce you to the Eisenhower Matrix, a decision-making tool devised by the 34th President of the United

States — a five-star general who accomplished a dizzying amount of important work in his two terms. Use the chart below to help determine which flare-ups could be delegated or ignored, and which ones actually deserve your precious attention.

THE EISENHOWER MATRIX

	URGENT	NOT URGENT
IMPORTANT	Drop Everything DO THESE TASKS RIGHT NOW EXAMPLES: > Client projects > Team deadlines > Family emergencies > Emails requiring a response TACTICS: > Use a timer to keep you focused and moving forward > Avoid burnout by anticipating these tasks	Carve Out Time PLAN AND PRIORITIZE THESE LONG-TERM GOALS EXAMPLES: > Exercise and nutrition > Relationship maintenance > Professional development > Home projects TACTICS: > Reserve regular blocks in your schedule for these tasks > Tie these tasks to your life values
NOT IMPORTANT	Delegate These Interruptions FIND SOMEONE ELSE TO CARRY THIS WEIGHT EXAMPLES: > Busywork, like paying bills > Requests from colleagues in other departments > Noncritical meetings > Unscheduled phone calls TACTICS: > Turn off phone notifications > Check email only three times a day > Practice saying no	Stop These Distractions CALL YOURSELF OUT WHEN YOU SLIP INTO AVOIDANCE AND PROCRASTINATION EXAMPLES: > Mindlessly scrolling social media > Online shopping > Organizing but not processing papers > Gaming or bingeing shows TACTICS: > Use tools to track your screen use > Use accountability partners > Reward yourself for breaking these bad habits

For more on using the Urgent-Important Matrix in your life, visit additu.de/dr-saline